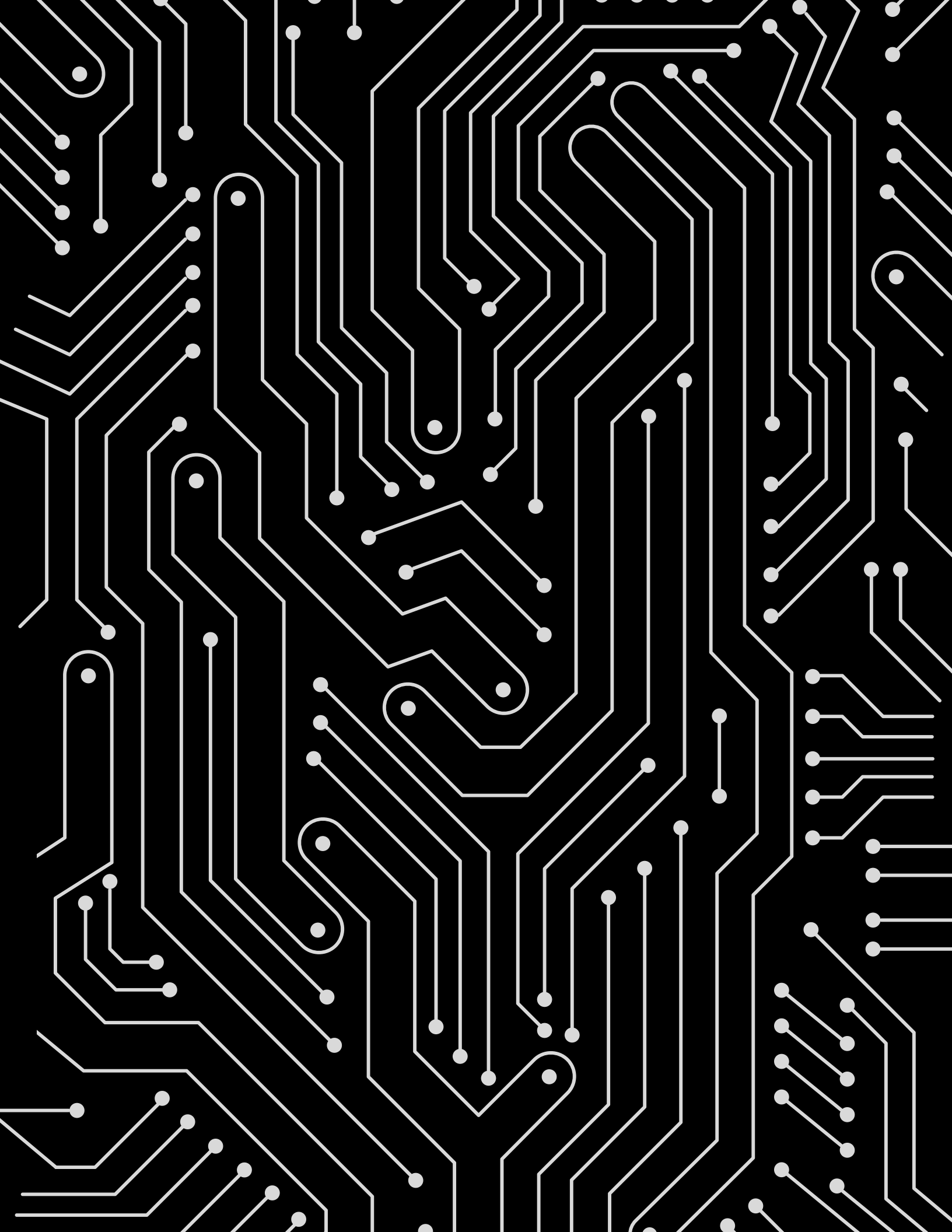


DAEMONCON 26

JAN. 23, 2026



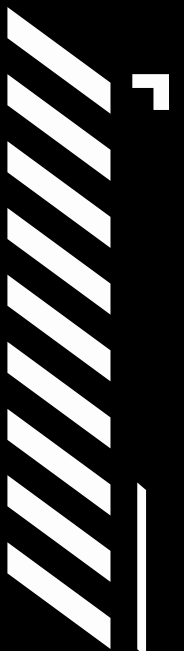
PRESENTED BY JEPÄUL
SECURITY DÆMONS



WELCOME

THE DAEMONCON SECURITY CONFERENCE IS AN EVENT THAT WILL PROVIDE ATTENDEES WITH INSIGHT IN THE CYBER FIELD. REGARDLESS, OF EXPERIENCE, THIS CONFERENCE AIMS TO PROVIDE PARTICIPANTS WITH AN EVEN DEEPER KNOWLEDGE OF THE CYBER FIELD THROUGH TALKS ON CRUCIAL SECURITY AREAS BY ITS PRESENTERS, HANDS-ON WORKSHOPS AND VILLAGES THROUGHOUT THE DAY, AND A CAPTURE THE FLAG (CTF) EVENT!

AT THE END OF THIS CONFERENCE, WE HOPE YOU GAINED MORE UNDERSTANDING OF THE CYBER WORLD THAN WHEN YOU CAME IN WITH TODAY AND HAD FUN!

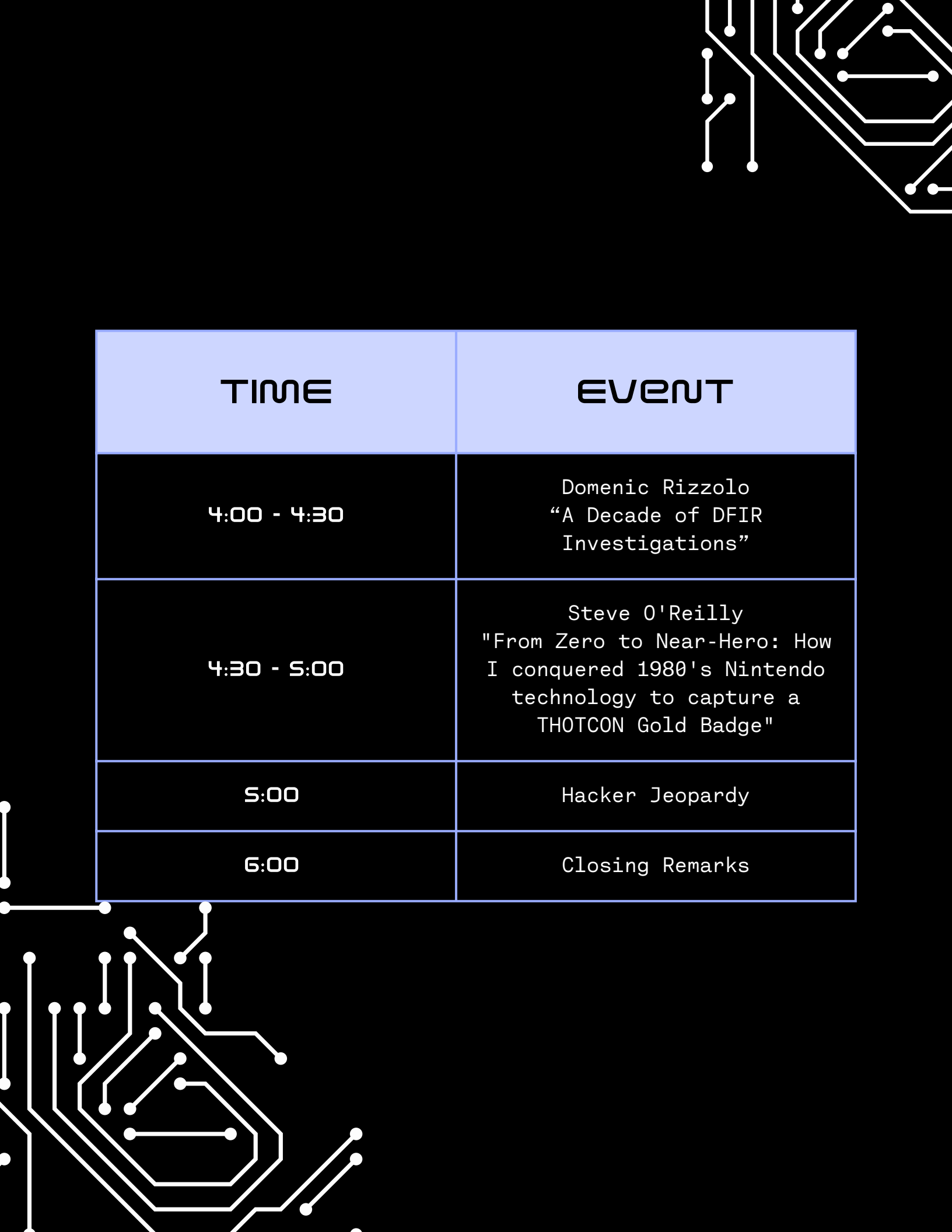


TO GET CONNECTED

1. Connect to DePaul Wifi
2. Get redirected to guestsetup.depaul.edu
3. Click register and enter "daemoncon2026" for the Conference ID

SCHEDULE

TIME	EVENT
10:00	Registration
10:30	Welcome
11:00 - 12:00	Ivana Donevska "Trends Change, Purpose Doesn't."
12:00 - 1:00	Lunch
1:00 - 2:00	Aaron Atac "Internet Infrastructure, Peering, and Observability Walkthrough"
2:00 - 2:30	AJ Van Beest "Agentic Threat Intel: Building an AI-Powered Intelligence Pipeline"
2:30 - 3:00	Derick Johnson "If you Can Talk, You can hack: Breaking Chatbots on Purpose"
3:00 - 4:00	Industry Panel Discussion



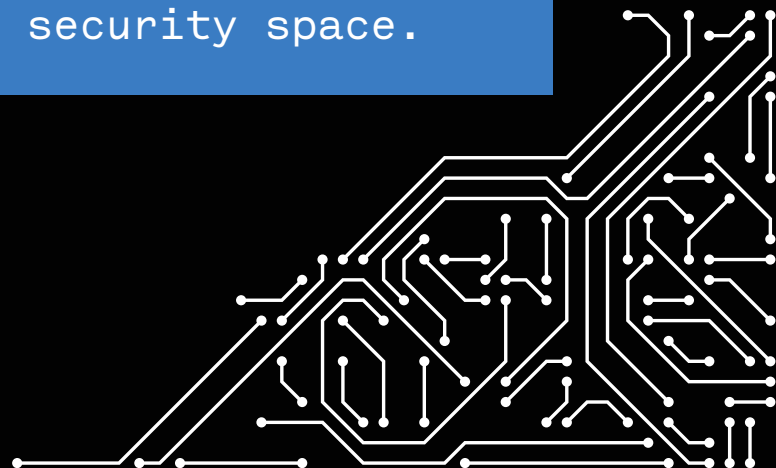
TIME	EVENT
4:00 - 4:30	Domenic Rizzolo “A Decade of DFIR Investigations”
4:30 - 5:00	Steve O'Reilly "From Zero to Near-Hero: How I conquered 1980's Nintendo technology to capture a THOTCON Gold Badge"
5:00	Hacker Jeopardy
6:00	Closing Remarks

SPEAKERS

IVANA DONEVSKA

" TRENDS CHANGE,
PURPOSE DOESN'T. "

Ikigai, the Japanese concept describing the convergence of purpose and contribution, offers a human-centered lens for the speakers to identify their passion in the ever changing field of technology, especially the digital security field. Example: As quantum technologies challenge classical notions of determinism, efficiency, and problem-solving, they also invite reflection on why and for whom such computational power is pursued. Similarly, this framework can be applied to LLM/AI trends and the overwhelming amount of technologies that dominate the market. This abstract explores how ikigai can function as an ethical and motivational framework, aligning technical innovation with personal meaning in the cyber security space.



AARON ATAC

"INTERNET INFRASTRUCTURE, PEERING, AND OBSERVABILITY WALKTHROUGH"

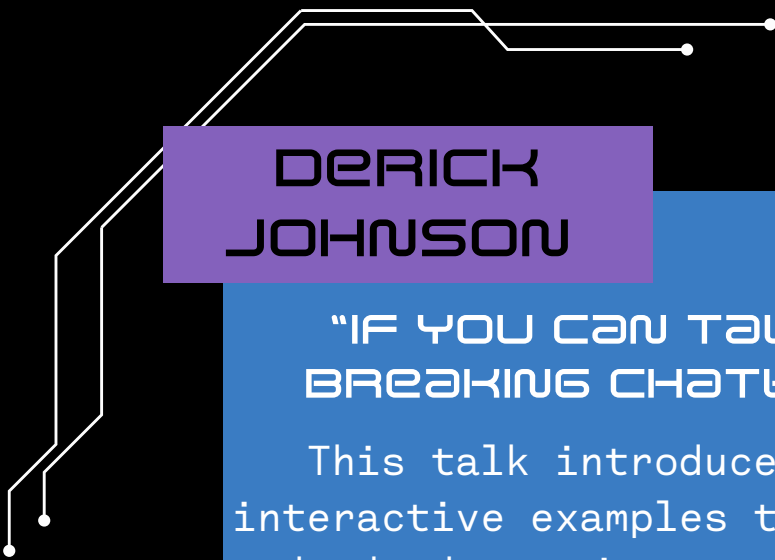
This presentation is a high-level walkthrough designed to welcome newcomers and non-engineers to the internet infrastructure community. Topics include physical infrastructure, economical business relationships, routing security, observational tooling, and measurement.

AJ VAN BEEST

"AGENTIC THREAT INTEL: BUILDING AN AI-POWERED INTELLIGENCE PIPELINE"

"Threat intelligence is drowning in noise. Feeds, blogs, advisories, social media - there's more signal out there than any analyst can process manually. What if you could build an AI agent that does the harvesting for you? This talk walks through building an agentic threat intel monitor from scratch, focusing on patterns you can apply to your own projects:

- Spec-Driven Development: Writing a clear specification that guides your AI agent's behavior - what to collect, how to evaluate, when to alert
- Source Discovery & Harvesting: Identifying valuable intel sources and automating collection without getting blocked or overwhelmed
- Letting AI Navigate Infrastructure: Using Claude to build and deploy in GCP - watching an agent provision its own resources
- Signal vs. Noise: Defining criteria that separate actionable intelligence from background chatter"



DERICK JOHNSON

"IF YOU CAN TALK, YOU CAN HACK: BREAKING CHATBOTS ON PURPOSE"

This talk introduces AI pentesting through interactive examples that show how chatbots can be broken using prompt injection and logic flaws. Attendees will learn how attackers manipulate AI behavior through conversation, explore common failure patterns, and gain practical testing techniques

DOMENIC RIZZOLO

"A DECADE OF DFIR INVESTIGATIONS"

Digital Forensics and Incident Response investigations can take many forms, spanning from expert witness testimony to years-long battles with APT's to phishing matters solved in a single call. Taking a step back, I will review my experiences from a decade plus of investigations: the headline making ones, the small ones, and the outright bizarre ones. I'll discuss general investigative techniques and how skills you build early in your career can outlive tools, forensic artifacts, and industry trends.

STEVE O'REILLY

"FROM ZERO TO NEAR-HERO: HOW I CONQUERED 1980'S NINTENDO TECHNOLOGY TO CAPTURE A THOTCON GOLD BADGE"

In 2017, THOTCON 0x8 held a Tool Assisted Speedrun (TAS) contest. Entrants submitted a video of a Nintendo Entertainment System (NES) game edited with the FCEUX application, an open-source NES and Family Computer Disk System emulator. FCEUX's TAS Editor enables the execution of a game's button presses with extreme precision. This allows a player to optimize the game sprite's speed, action and timing with a goal of completing the game as quickly as possible. In essence, a TAS video is animation with a console game as the medium. The TAS contest presented an opportunity to learn the FCEUX application and then demonstrate creativity in producing a video that would be judged on style and performance as opposed to speed. Prior to entering, I had never heard of TAS videos and my gaming experience was limited to casual play at best. I also had no experience in editing Read Only Memory (ROM) of NES games. But my passion for learning how things work and getting stuff for free compelled me to take up the challenge. This turbo talk will summarize how I approached the contest's scope and then created the winning entry

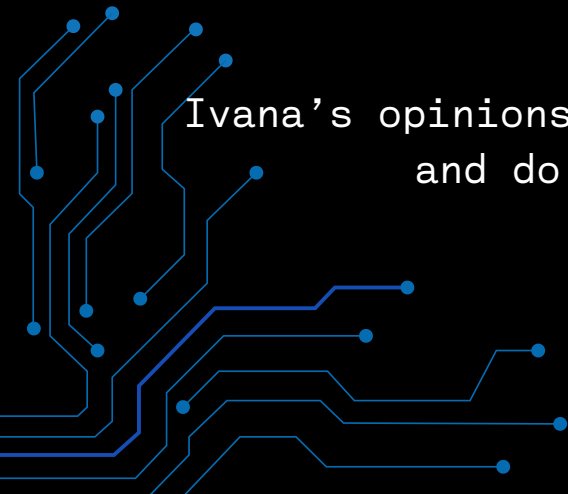


BIOS

Ivana Donevska

Ivana is BMO's US Data Analytics and AI Risk Head and named CDO Magazine's Top 25 Chicago CDOs and 40 under 40 CDOs for 2025. She is an experienced Chief Data & Analytics and AI Officer (CDAAI0) who has successfully modernized, transformed, and enabled digital and advanced analytics capabilities by unlocking business value for the Banking, Media/Marketing, Healthcare, and Education sectors. Ivana received her Executive Management and Pricing for Profitability Certifications from the University of Chicago Booth School of Business, and her Master's in Computer Science from Purdue University, where she also taught. Ivana has presented at multiple industry events and conferences, is a scientifically published author and has sponsored award-winning practicums for the UofI Urbana Champaign Masters in Financial Engineering. As a thought industry leader, she is a member of the Evanta CDAO Chicago Chapter governing body.

Ivana's opinions shared during the event are her own and do not represent her company.



Aaron Atac

Aaron Atac is a DePaul SecDaemons alumnus, currently focused on building infrastructure for AI and GPU workloads. Previously, he served as Principal Network Engineer at Akamai, specializing in global backbone architecture, traffic engineering, and routing security. An active member of the internet community, Aaron serves on the NANOG Hackathon committee, working to make network engineering accessible to the next generation.

AJ Van Beest

AJ Van Beest is the technical lead for the AI Security Operations team at Dexcom, Inc.

He's been deeply involved in security operations for a decade, and has spent the last two years using AI to make everything -- from grocery shopping to malware analysis -- faster / better / harder / stronger.

When AJ's not in front of his computer, he's generally sailing off-shore in Lake Michigan, cursing "that damn pickleball," or getting trampled by one of his fur babies

Derick Johnson

Derick Johnson is a cybersecurity graduate student specializing in offensive security, OSINT, and network reconnaissance. He holds CEH and eJPT certifications. Derick has delivered technical talks and workshops on reconnaissance, red teaming, and automation, focusing on practical techniques that bridge theory and real-world security operations.

Domenic Rizzolo

Originally from Chicago, Domenic studied math at University of Michigan where he got his first opportunity in security as a student researcher. Since 2015, he has been working data breaches and complex investigations at Stroz Friedberg (now LevelBlue) where he also runs the first year associate and internship programs for DFIR. He devours books about inconsequential history, loves learning and teaching, and has been to all 50 states.

Robert Wagner

Robert Wagner is an Advisory CISO and highly respected security practitioner, advisor and strategist with over 20 years of experience.

His security experience ranges from defending everything from Fortune 500 companies to government agencies, major universities, and financial institutions. He is a co-founder of the not-for-profit organization Hak4Kidz, serves on the boards of the Chicago ISSA chapter and the Chicago CISO of the Year Committee, and regularly volunteers for various hacker cons including Bsid3s312, BlueTeamCon, and others



VILLAGES

HARDWARE VILLAGE

Hardware Village brings together hands-on hardware hacking and wireless security in one interactive space, giving attendees a practical look at how everyday devices communicate and where their security can fail. Participants will explore real consumer and IoT devices through live, non-malicious demonstrations that highlight firmware analysis, hardware interfaces, and wireless vulnerabilities. A dedicated radio security component introduces the fundamentals of the radio spectrum, signal capture, and replay attacks, showing how signals from devices like routers, key fobs, and NFC systems can be analyzed by defenders. Designed for both beginners and advanced learners, this village offers a rare opportunity to see how hardware, firmware, and radio security intersect in real-world systems.

WORKSHOPS

CERTIFIED VIBE HACKER | 12:30 - 2:30

Course Leader: Robert Wagner

Whether you're breaking systems, defending them, or doing both, most security professionals don't need more tools—they need more time, focus, and leverage. This workshop explores how agentic AI can support day-to-day red team, blue team, and purple team work by reducing cognitive overhead and accelerating analysis. Participants learn vibe hacking: a hands-on approach to steering AI behavior toward useful outcomes like hypothesis generation, synthesis, and prioritization. Through practical exercises using a reference interactive AI toolset, attendees experiment with workflows that help them deliver higher-quality results under real-world constraints—without automating humans out of the loop.



INTRO TO HARDWARE AND WIRELESS SECURITY

Course Leader: Joel John

Duration: The Whole Convention

Come learn how to hack embedded devices! We will have sessions explaining the basics you will need to start your hardware hacking journey and test devices around you! We will also cover basics so you understand how we can exploit hardware flaws in devices around us and how to hack a wireless access point.

Bonus: we will also explore cloning RFID cards/tags, wireless pentesting and even spoofing signals from a car key fob (BYO key fob)!

Requirements: NA



PowerShell



DaemonCon PowerShell

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Check out all the latest things from the Security Daemons at
secdaemons.org!

PS C:\Users\Daemon> start "C:\home\files\hackerjeopardy.txt"

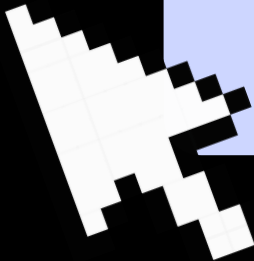
hacker...



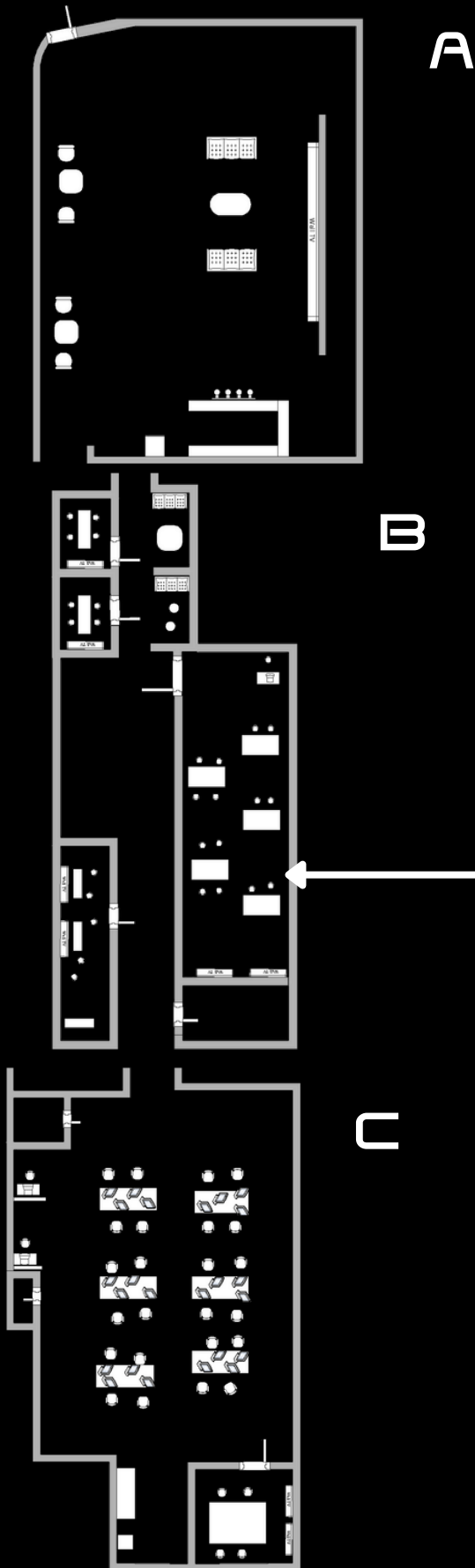
Hacker Jeopardy!!

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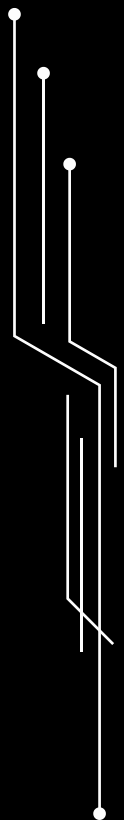
Register at the Front Desk



MAP



A. Jarvis Center
Main Entrance
B. Jarvis Center
Conference Rooms
C. Jarvis Center
PC Lab



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THANK YOU TO ALL WHO MADE THIS YEARS DAEMONCON POSSIBLE!

Thank you to CDM to the staff Sam Cabrera, Elly Kafritsas-Wessels, Joshua Tsui for allowing to use their space.

To SAF-B and CDM for helping make this years daemoncon wonderful!

To all our speakers and volunteers we couldn't done this without you.

And of course our attendees!



Organizers

Ryan Haley

Aliana Moore

Brandon Dudas

Workshop Leads

Joel John

Robert Wagner

CTF Design

Derrick Johnson

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